

Meteor shower

If a lump of rock or metal burns up before it reaches the ground, it is called a meteor or shooting star. This photograph shows lots of them falling together in a meteor shower.

Crash! Bang!

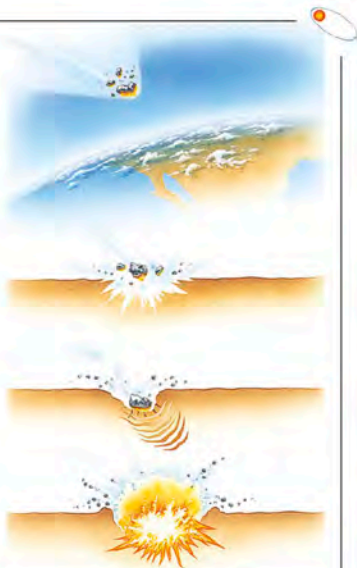
A large meteor that does not burn up as it plunges through the Earth's atmosphere is called a meteorite.

It travels so fast it shatters into pieces as it hits the ground.

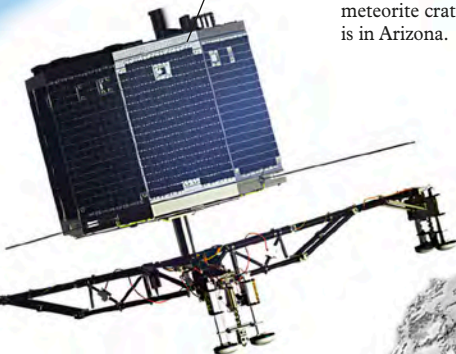
It causes shock waves as it lands.

The explosion leaves a big hole, called a crater.

This huge meteorite crater is in Arizona.



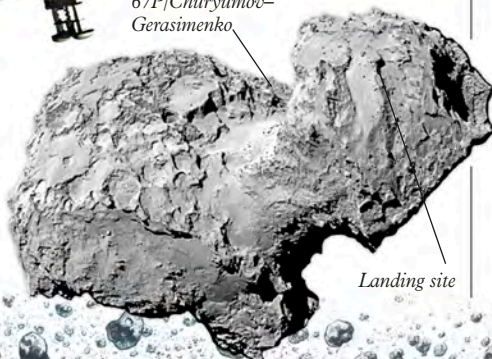
Philae lander module



Comet quest

The Rosetta mission launched in 2004 and finished in 2016, when the Philae lander module successfully landed on comet 67P/Churyumov-Gerasimenko.

67P/Churyumov-Gerasimenko



Landing site